



IT & Cybersecurity Governance Manual

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1. Governance Charter

1.1. Policy Statement

- 1.1.1. Pakistan Cables Limited (PCL) shall operate a centralized IT and cybersecurity governance framework aligned with NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF 2.0) and ISO/IEC 27001:2022.
- 1.1.2. All digital assets, systems, cloud platforms, AI tools, and technology services shall originate, operate, and be maintained under IT governance authority.

2. Governance Structure

2.1. Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

- 2.1.1. The CEO is the executive owner of cyber risk.
- 2.1.2. The CEO shall:
 - Approve high-risk exceptions to technology governance policies.
 - Chair or oversee executive-level IT & cybersecurity governance reviews.

2.2. IT Steering Committee (ITSC)

- 2.2.1. The ITSC acts as the operational governance body for technology decisions.
- 2.2.2. Key responsibilities include:
 - Reviewing and approving major IT investments.
 - Evaluating technology risks and business alignment.
 - Ensuring technology standardization across departments.
 - Monitoring progress of IT & cybersecurity initiatives.
- 2.2.3. The ITSC shall meet periodically to review:
 - IT risk posture
 - Digital transformation initiatives
 - Technology architecture compliance
 - Vendor and technology risks

2.3. Business Heads

- 2.3.1. Business heads are owners of digital usage risk within their departments.
- 2.3.2. They are responsible for:
 - Ensuring technology usage within their departments follows IT governance procedures.
 - Submitting justified requests for new technology solutions.
 - Ensuring employees comply with acceptable use and security requirements.



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- Supporting incident reporting and risk mitigation efforts.

2.3.3. Business heads shall not independently procure or deploy technology solutions outside the structured IT governance framework.

2.4. Head of IT

2.4.1. The Head of IT is responsible for implementation and enforcement of technology governance.

2.4.2. Responsibilities include:

- Maintaining technology standards and architecture.
- Implementing cybersecurity controls aligned with NIST and ISO frameworks.
- Conducting risk assessments for new technologies.
- Ensure cross-department compliance with IT governance.
- Ensure IT governance aligns with corporate strategy.
- Ensuring compliance monitoring and reporting.

2.5. IT Security Function

2.5.1. The IT Security function provides independent oversight of cybersecurity risk.

2.5.2. Responsibilities include:

- Performing security risk assessments.
- Monitoring compliance with security controls.
- Investigating cybersecurity incidents.
- Providing advisory support to the ITSC and executive leadership.

3. Digital Acquisition Governance

3.1. All hardware, software, SaaS, AI platforms, and cloud services shall follow the Structured Digital Intake Process:

- Business justification submission
- IT technical & cybersecurity assessment
- Risk classification
- Approval reference issuance
- Procurement execution
- Asset / license registration
- Secure configuration & deployment



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3.2. Procurement and Finance systems shall require IT approval references before PO issuance or payment release.

3.3. All digital/ technology acquisition requests must enter through IT Service Desk.

3.4. Following details shall be provided:

- Business justification
- Data classification
- Risk category
- Budget owner
- System integration impact

3.5. No digital acquisition, subscription, or technology deployment shall proceed without documented IT authorization.

4. Asset & Configuration Governance

4.1. PCL shall maintain:

- 4.1.1. Centralized Asset Register
- 4.1.2. Software & License Register
- 4.1.3. SaaS & Cloud Register
- 4.1.4. AI Tool Register
- 4.1.5. Vendor Risk Register

4.2. No system shall connect to the corporate network without:

- 4.2.1. Asset registration
- 4.2.2. Security baseline configuration
- 4.2.3. Endpoint protection installation
- 4.2.4. Identity binding

5. Identity & Access Governance

5.1. All systems must:

- 5.1.1. Use corporate identity (SSO integration)
- 5.1.2. Enforce MFA
- 5.1.3. Apply least privilege
- 5.1.4. Undergo quarterly access review
- 5.1.5. Be automatically deprovisioned on exit



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5.2. No personal email-based subscriptions permitted.

6. Data Protection & Cloud Governance

6.1. PCL shall ensure:

- 6.1.1. Encryption at rest and in transit
- 6.1.2. Data classification enforcement
- 6.1.3. Cloud vendor due diligence
- 6.1.4. Data residency evaluation
- 6.1.5. Exit & data deletion assurance

6.2. Upload of PCL data to external platforms without IT authorization is prohibited.

7. Monitoring & Detection

7.1. PCL shall implement:

- 7.1.1. Centralized logging
- 7.1.2. SaaS usage visibility
- 7.1.3. License compliance reviews
- 7.1.4. Vulnerability and patch management
- 7.1.5. Quarterly governance reporting to CEO

8. Incident Response & Cyber Resilience

8.1. PCL shall maintain a structured incident response capability.

8.2. PCL shall maintain:

- 8.2.1. Incident classification matrix
- 8.2.2. Ransomware containment protocol
- 8.2.3. Executive notification procedure
- 8.2.4. Disaster recovery procedures (RTO/RPO defined)

8.3. The incident response lifecycle includes:

- Detection
- Containment
- Investigation
- Recovery
- Post-incident review



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9. Risk Management & Exceptions

9.1. Exceptions require:

- Documented risk assessment
- Compensating controls
- CEO approval for high-risk deviations
- Inclusion in centralized risk register

APPROVED BY
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER